



1435 CAPITAL CHALLENGE

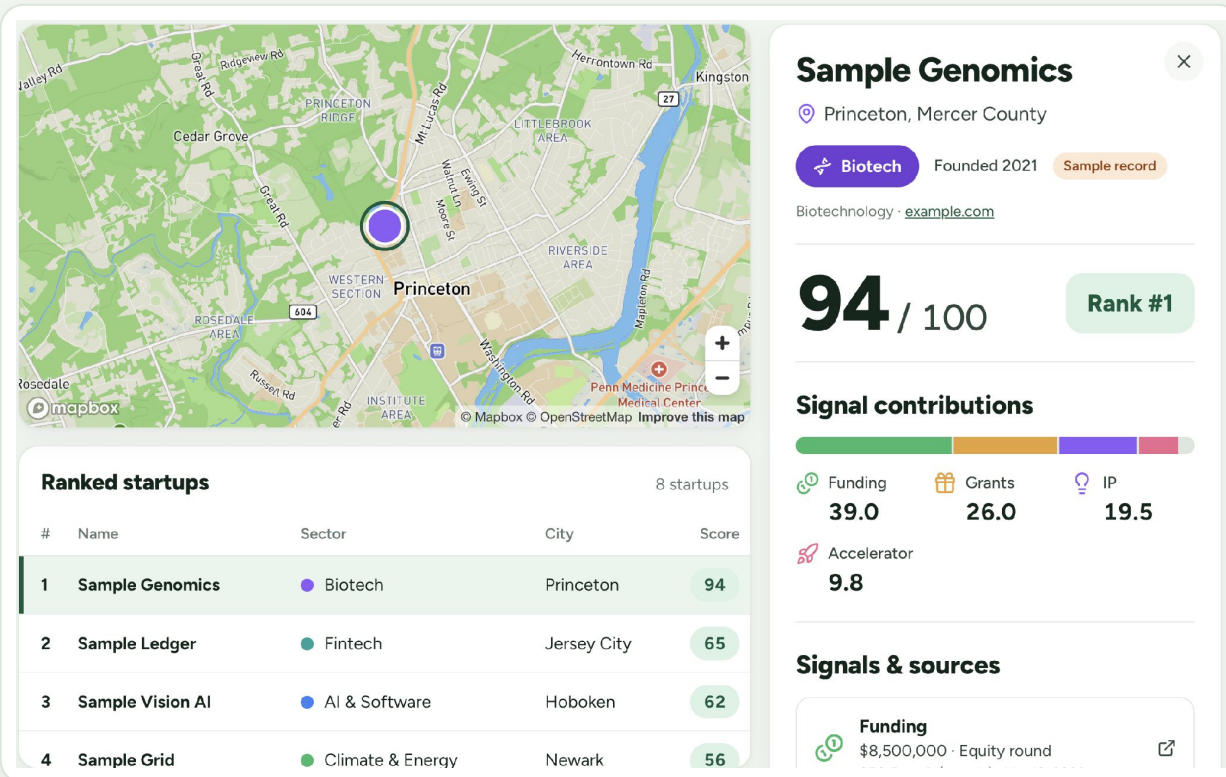
NJ Startup Signals

Discover New Jersey's next wave of startups.

A map and ranked view of early momentum.

Mighty Ducks

- Phil Rodriguez
- YiChin Ho
- Luke Daniel
- Tewan Pothibutt



Concept preview · Sample data

Promising startups are hard to spot early.

Finding the signals still means searching across sources.

That makes it harder to see which companies and sectors are gaining traction.

6

separate places to look
before evaluation can begin



Funding



Grants



Hiring



IP filings



Accelerators



Public support

Scattered across funding records, grant databases, job boards, IP registries and program listings

A map of startups. A ranked view of momentum.

0–100

Startup Score

Built from six types of ecosystem signals



Map

Locate companies across New Jersey



Leaderboard

Compare startups by score



Company profiles

Explore the signals behind each company



Sector clusters

See momentum across industries

Discover earlier. Evaluate faster.

Build relationships before the opportunity is widely known.



01

Competing for access

Other investors may reach promising companies first.



02

Fragmented information

Gathering signals takes time before evaluation can begin.



03

Earlier assessment

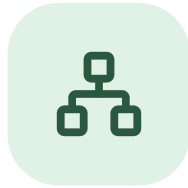
Combined signals help teams start evaluating sooner.

Built for those who spot and support growth.



Investors

- Find and compare emerging opportunities.
- Start evaluating companies earlier.



Ecosystem builders

- Connect startups with programs and networks.
- See companies and sectors across the ecosystem.



Economic development groups

- Understand growth by location and industry.
- Inform regional development priorities.

Shared signals. Different views and scoring weights for each group.

The signals behind the score.



Funding

Capital raised and funding rounds

SEC Form D



Grants

Award dollars and program participation

SBIR · NIH · NSF · NJEDA



Hiring

Open roles and technical-role share

Job posting platforms



Intellectual property

Recent patent and trademark filings

Patent & trademark records



Accelerators

Accelerator or incubator participation

Program & event listings



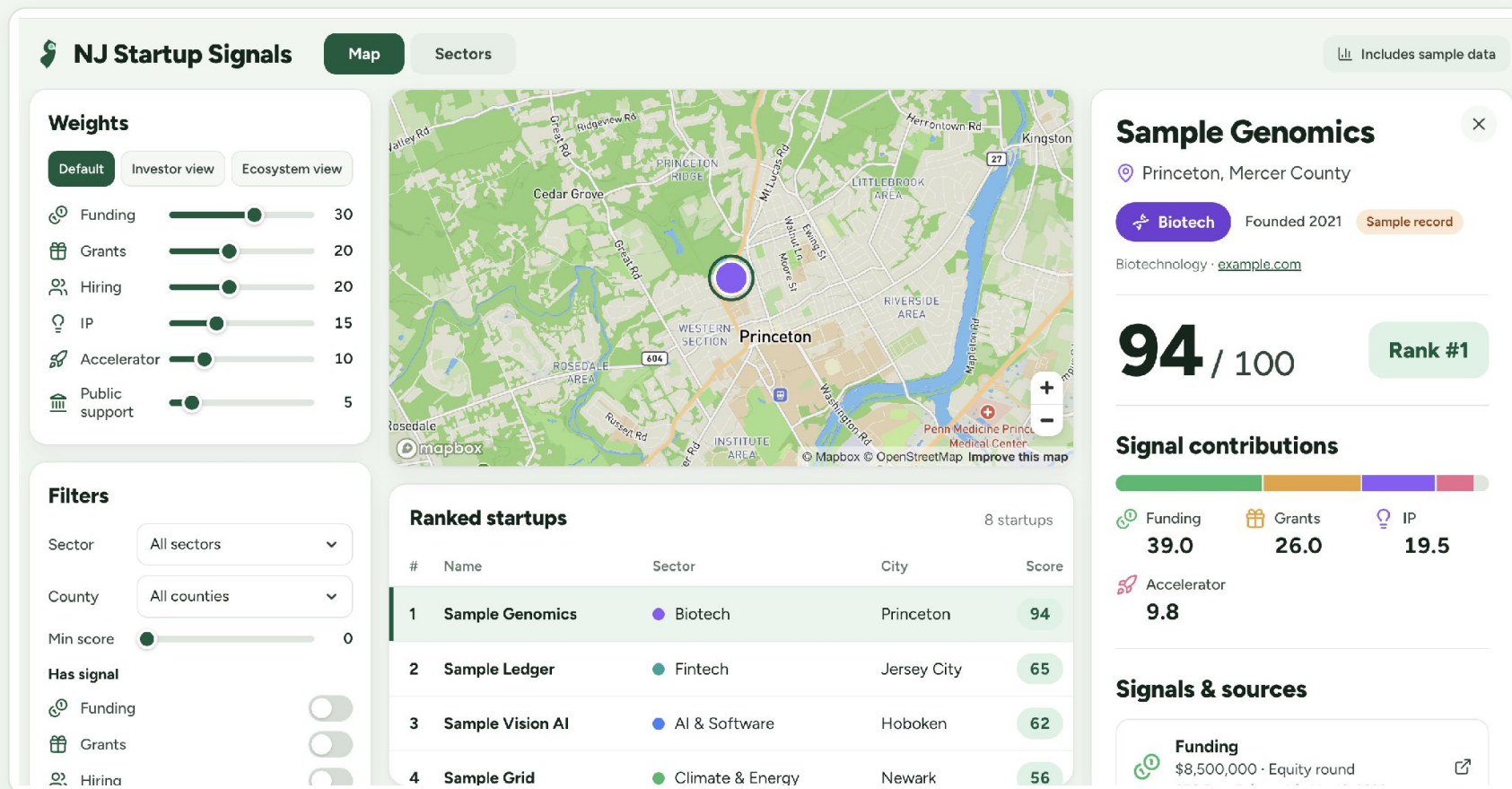
Public support

Programs, awards, and press

NJEDA & other public sources

Public and permissioned data, with sample data clearly labeled.

Explore the ecosystem.



Mapbox map

Pin color = sector
Pin size = score



Ranked list

Rank, name, sector,
city, and score



Zoom & layers

Cluster pins on zoom-out.
Optional county heatmap.

A closer look at each company.



STEP 01

Filter

- Sector and county
- Minimum score
- Funding, grants, hiring, IP, and accelerator signals



STEP 02

Select

- Click a company in the list.
- The map flies to its pin.
- Or select the pin directly.



STEP 03

Explore

- Company overview and location
- Sector and Startup Score
- Detected ecosystem signals

How the Startup Score is built.



- Funding** Amount raised and number of rounds
- Grants** Award dollars, with SBIR Phase II weighted 2× Phase I
- Hiring** Open roles and share of technical roles
- IP** Recent patent and trademark filings
- Accelerator / incubator** Participation, with a boost for selective programs
- Public support & other** NJEDA programs, awards, and press

Normalize each signal. Combine using the selected weights.
Boost companies with several independent signal types.

Rank opportunities through your lens.



Adjust one slider per signal.

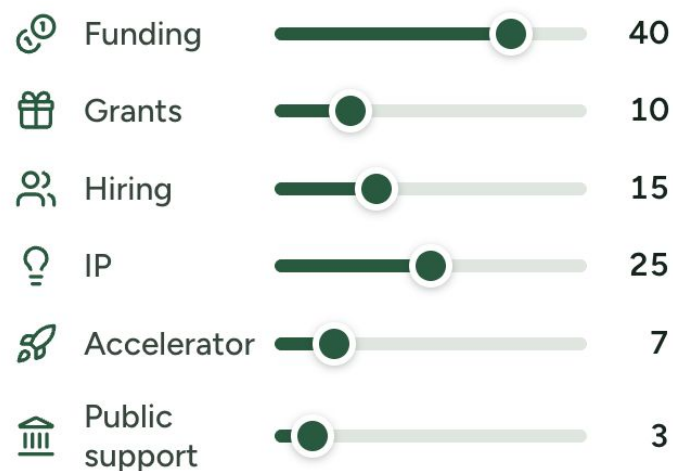
Rankings update live.

Same signal base, different evaluation priorities.

Investor view

Funding + IP

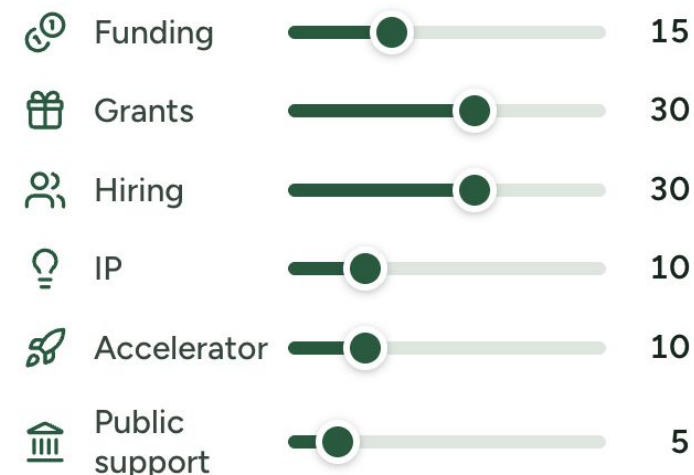
Emphasize capital activity and intellectual property.



Ecosystem view

Hiring + Grants

Emphasize workforce expansion and grant support.



Slider positions are illustrative.

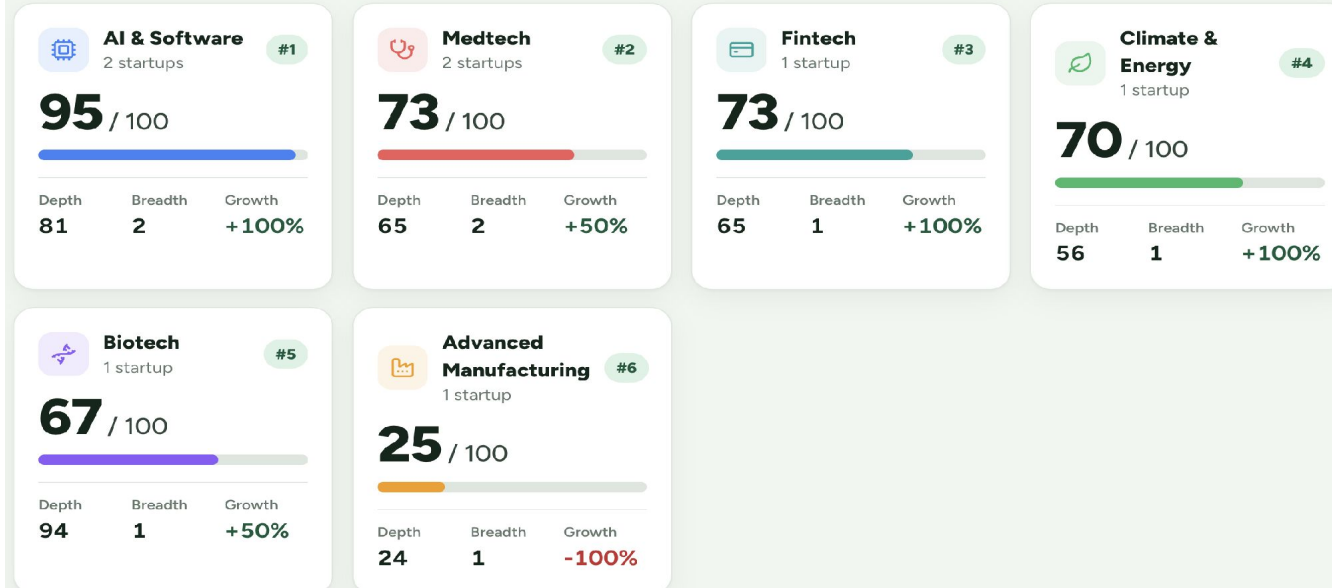
Momentum across industries.

Company count by sector

Illustrative data

Sectors

Depth adds up the scores of each sector's top five startups. Breadth counts startups with two or more signal types. Growth compares signal activity in the last 12 months with the 12 before.



COMPARE SECTORS BY



Depth



Breadth



Year-over-year growth

Sample data demonstrates the view, not actual New Jersey sector performance.

See the opportunity early.

A few hundred

New Jersey companies.



01

Working prototype

Map, ranked list, and company profiles



02

Startup scoring

Signal filters and adjustable weights



03

Sector intelligence

Clusters and trends across the state

Real data where quick to access. Clearly labeled samples where needed.